# THONG PHAM

**SOFTWARE ENGINEERING / LLM EVALUATION / APPLIED ML**

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## EXPERIENCE

### Mercor
March 2025 - Present

**Software Engineer & Tooling**
San Francisco, CA

- Built Python tooling with GPT-5, Gemini, and other LLM APIs to validate dataset and label quality across AI labs, increasing testing throughput by **~40%**.
- Designed **Snowflake-to-Hex pipelines** and dashboards tracking model performance and label coverage, cutting manual data processing time by **~25%**.
- Engineered intake, QA feedback, reviewer handoffs, and merge workflows; standardized acceptance criteria and maintained **<1% post-evaluation defect rates**.
- Served as a quality SME, clarifying ambiguous requirements and edge cases for reviewers and the Strategic Project Lead.

**Software Engineer LLM**

- Resolved hundreds of LLM/data issues weekly across Python, Java, and C/C++ services, including API integrations and rate limiting; maintained a **first-pass fix rate above 99%**.
- Worked with research scientists and product managers to turn ambiguous requirements into implementation-ready specs, reducing feature iteration time by **20%**.
- Reviewed evaluator outputs against project guidelines and provided actionable feedback to improve reviewer consistency and adherence to acceptance criteria.

### Kashmir World Foundation
September 2024 - February 2025

**Machine Learning Engineer Intern**
Richmond, VA

- Applied **XGBoost, PyTorch, and OpenCV** to over **200K audio/video clips**, achieving **91.6% classification accuracy** through data ingestion, hyperparameter tuning, and deployment.
- Used EDA, random forests, correlation analysis, and feature selection to improve interpretability of signal-based datasets for domain experts.
- Built **Power BI and Tableau dashboards** to communicate modeling insights and species-behavior trends to conservation researchers and decision-makers.

### Stealth Startup
February 2023 - June 2024

**Software Engineer**
Irvine, CA

- Delivered **LLM-powered finance features** in Python, owning prompt design, API orchestration, and output post-processing for transaction-data workflows.
- Built evaluation scripts for report generation and risk/exception handling to detect degradations as prompts and logic evolved.
- Created a **Python regression test harness**, curated transaction scenarios, and converted production bugs into repeatable pre-deployment tests to reduce recurring release issues.

## EDUCATION

**University of Colorado Boulder**
June 2024 - December 2025 | Boulder, CO
M.S. Computer Science | Machine Learning specialization | GPA 4.0 / 4.0

**University of California, Irvine**
September 2019 - December 2022 | Irvine, CA
B.A. Business Economics

## TECHNICAL SKILLS & LANGUAGES

**Programming & ML:** Python, R, Java, C/C++, SQL; TensorFlow, scikit-learn, Keras, PyTorch, Seaborn, OpenCV, XGBoost.
**Tools:** Git (CI/CD), Docker, Airtable, Power BI, Tableau, Excel, Google Sheets, Google Workspace, Hex.
**Data & cloud:** AWS (S3, EC2), Google Cloud Platform, Snowflake.
**Languages:** English (native), Vietnamese (native), Spanish (intermediate).